

Product Return Policy

Policy ID: RET-001 **Version:** 2.4 **Effective Date:** January 1, 2026
Owner: Customer Experience **Review Frequency:** Semiannual

1. Purpose

This policy defines the requirements for returning purchased products and receiving an eligible refund or replacement.

2. Standard Return Window

Eligible products may generally be returned within **30 calendar days of confirmed delivery**.

The return period begins on the date the order is recorded as delivered.

For orders with multiple products delivered separately, the return period applies independently to each delivered product.

3. Return Eligibility

A product may be eligible for return when:

- * It was purchased through an authorized sales channel.
- * The return request is within the applicable return period.
- * The product is eligible for return.
- * Required product information can be verified.

Some product categories may have additional restrictions.

4. Product Condition

Returned products should generally be:

- * In reasonable condition.
- * Accompanied by required accessories where applicable.
- * Accompanied by documentation where required.
- * Packaged appropriately for return shipping.

Products that show substantial damage caused after delivery may require additional investigation.

5. Defective Products

Defective products may be handled under the warranty process rather than the standard return process.

If a customer reports a defect:

1. Verify the product. 2. Determine whether the issue appears to be a manufacturing defect. 3. Check warranty eligibility. 4. Follow the warranty procedure when applicable.

The agent should not automatically classify every product complaint as a warranty claim.

6. Non-Returnable Products

Certain categories may have return restrictions for operational, legal, hygiene, personalization, or safety reasons.

When a product appears to be restricted:

* Check the applicable product category policy. * Do not promise that the item can be returned. * Escalate ambiguous cases.

7. Return Shipping

Responsibility for return shipping may depend on the reason for the return.

Examples include:

* Incorrect product shipped. * Defective product. * Customer preference. * Product not as described. * Other approved exception.

The applicable policy should be checked before promising reimbursement of return shipping costs.

8. Refund After Return

Receiving a returned package does not necessarily mean that a refund has already been approved.

The returned product may require inspection or verification.

Support should distinguish between:

* Return initiated. * Return received. * Return inspected. * Refund approved. * Refund processed.

9. Exceptions

Customers may request an exception when:

* The return window has recently expired. * The customer experienced a documented delivery issue. * The product has a verified defect. * An operational error caused the customer to miss the normal return process.

Exceptions require human review.

10. Automated Agent Restrictions

The automated agent may explain eligibility requirements and recommend next steps.

It must not:

- * Guarantee approval. * Override the return window. * Approve an exception.
- * Promise reimbursement. * Modify return records.

11. Escalation

Human review is required when:

- * The return window has expired. * Product eligibility is unclear. * A customer requests an exception. * Product condition is disputed. * A return appears fraudulent or inconsistent. * The applicable product category has conflicting rules.

12. Decision Principle

The system should distinguish between **return eligibility** and **refund approval**.

A customer may be eligible to initiate a return without an immediate refund being guaranteed.